Mean Girls – Original Screenplay

By Tina Fey

(offstage) African Music from Lion King

CADY: **(Pg 6)** *(to audience)* Hi, my name is Cady Heron. **(Pg 2)** I'm 15, and until today, I was homeschooled. That means my mom was my only teacher and my Dad was the only sub. I know what you're thinking. Home-schooled kids are freaks.

Cut to the Scripps Howard Spelling Bee

SPAZZY GIRL: *(at microphone, speaking loudly)* X! Y! L! O! CI A! R! PI Xylocarp!

CADY: Or that we're weirdly religious or something.

8-YEAR-OLD-KID: And on the third day God created the Remington bolt action rifle so that man could fight the dinosaurs.

CADY: **(Pg 3)** But my family's totally normal. Except that both my parents are research zoologists and we've spent the last four years in a hut in Namibia.

KAREN: **(Pg 16)** So, if you're from Africa, why are you white?

GRETCHEN: Oh, my God, Karen. You can't just ask people why they're white!

CADY: **(Pg 4)** Then it happened. My mom's articles about large cats earned her a full professorship at Northwestern University. So it was goodbye, Africa. Hello, Evanston, Illinois.

INTRODUCTION

Cady Heron may be a world traveler, but she has a lot to learn about navigating the treacherous outback known as high school; filled with back-stabbing, sarcasm, and vicious cliques – especially if you're a girl! Fortunately, on the very 1st day of school, she meets Damian and Janis who explain the social pecking order led by The Plastics and Queen Bee Regina George.

Mean Girls – The Original Screenplay by Tina Fey

DAMIAN: **(Pg 10-11)** [Hi, I'm Damian and] I am so going to mentor you. The cafeteria is terrible. Buy your lunch at the school store. I recommend the white cheddar cheezits. What else? Oh! Spring Fling! *(sees a gym class trudging out onto the field)* In

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

the name of all that is holy. Look at Karen Smith's gym clothes!

JANIS: Karen is one of the dumbest girls you will ever meet. Damian sat next to her in English class last year.

DAMIAN: She asked me how to spell orange!

JANIS: And that little one next to her? That's Gretchen Wieners. She's rich cause her Dad invented Toaster Strudel.

DAMIAN: She is a little Gucci Hootche – A girl with a $1,000 of designer clothes on a $2.00 body.

JANIS: **(Pg 17)** *(pointing and whispering)* [That's] Regina George. She is the most plastic of all The Plastics.

DAMIAN: She is fabulous, but she is evil.

******* Later that Day in the Cafeteria *******

MR. DUVALL: **(Pg 15)** Please give a round of applause for the head of the Student Activities Committee Miss Regina George!

REGINA: Thank you! Under my rule the SAC will do more than just sell candy canes and sponsor stuff like recycling. It's gonna be about being kind to the less fortunate. Where's that new student? *(she spots Cady in the crowd)* Come here! *(Cady joins her on stage)* I'm going to make it my personal responsibility that by the end of the year, she thinks Evanston High school is totally rad.

A few minutes later – Cady is sitting with Regina, Karen and Gretchen (The Plastics)

CADY: **(Pg 16)** And we only moved here two weeks ago—

REGINA: *(Regina grabs Cady's arm)* Where did you get that bracelet? I love it.

CADY: Africa.

GRETCHEN: It's so fetch.

REGINA: *(disdainful)* What is "fetch?"

GRETCHEN: *(withering)* It's, like, slang . . . from England . . .

REGINA: **(Pg 27)** *(rolls her eyes)* You know what, Cady? You're, like, actually really pretty.

CADY: Thank you.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

REGINA: *(snarky)* So you agree?

CADY: What?

REGINA: You ***think*** you're really pretty.

CADY: I didn't say that. *(to audience)* What just happened?

REGINA: **(Pg 16-17)** *(haughtily)* Cadv, could you give us some privacy for, like, one second? *(huddles and whispers with the other two plastics)* Okay, let me just say that we don't do this a lot, so you should know that this is, like, a huge deal.

GRETCHEN: We want to invite you to have lunch with us every day for the rest of the week. So we'll see you tomorrow.

KAREN: On Tuesdays we wear pink!

CADY: **(Pg 19)** *(to audience)* Having lunch with the Plastics was like leaving the actual world and entering "Girl World." And Girl World had a lot of rules.

KAREN: We only wear jeans or track pants on Friday.

GRETCHEN: You can't wear a tank top two days in a row.

REGINA: You can only wear your hair in a ponytail once a week. So, I guess, you picked today. **(Pg 80)** I'm starving. *(leaves to get lunch)*

GRETCHEN: **(Pg 19-21)** And if you break any of these rules you can't sit with us at lunch. I mean, not just you, any of us. Like, if I was wearing jeans today, I would be sitting over there with the art freaks. *(points to Janis and Damian's table)*

KAREN: You have to be considerate of the rest of the group. I mean, you wouldn't buy a skirt without asking your friends first if it looks good on you. It's the same with guys. You may think you like someone, but you could be wrong. Have you seen anyone that you think is cute yet?

CADY: Actually, there's a guy in my Calculus class. His name is Aaron Samuels—

KAREN: No, no no.

GRETCHEN: No. You can **NOT** like Aaron Samuels. He's Regina's ex-boyfriend. And then he broke up with her for no reason.

KAREN: Because she cheated on . . .

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

GRETCHEN: Regardless. Ex-boyfriends are off limits to friends. Don't worry. I will ***never*** tell Regina what you said. It'll be our secret. *(Regina enters with her food)*

REGINA: Ugh. There's gonna be a fire drill in, like, two seconds. *(Fire alarm goes off)* I told Coach Farr we had to skip it cause Karen might be pregnant.

KAREN: *(laughs, then)* I'm not though, right?

GRETCHEN: **(Pg 23-24)** Oh, my god, there's Jason! . . . *(heartbroken)* He's with Taylor Wedell.

REGINA: *(outraged)* Wait. No. He cannot blow you off like that. Gimme your phone. *(dials)* Wedell on South Boulevard *(pushes another button on phone – then in a mature voice)* Hello, may I speak to Taylor Wedell please? This is Susan at Planned Parenthood. I have her test results. Have her give me a call. Today, if she can. It's urgent. Thanks. *(she hangs up, Regina and Gretchen laugh)* She is not going out tonight!

CADY: *(wide-eyed to audience)* I could see why it was good to have Regina as a friend. *(beat)* I guess the Plastics liked having me as a pet, cause by Friday I was invited to Regina's house after school. *(to Regina)* Regina, your house is really nice.

REGINA I know, right?

MRS. GEORGE: **(Pg 25)** You want anything, don't be shy, honey. There's no rules here. I'm not like a regular mom, I'm a cool mom, right, Regina?

REGINA: *(exiting)* Please stop talking. *(Regina opens the door to her huge bedroom)* This is my room *(The girls settle in which involves looking at themselves in the many mirrors)*

KAREN: **(Pg 23)** So how was your first week?

CADY: Good. I'm joining the Mathletes.

REGINA: No, no, no. That is social suicide. You are so lucky you have us to guide you.

GRETCHEN: **(Pg 26-27)** I never should have bought these capri pants.

REGINA: How many times do I have to tell you? The Gap is for old people.

GRETCHEN: I hate my calves.

KAREN: God, my hips are so huge.

CADY: *(to audience)* Before I met the Plastics, I thought there was just fat and skinny. Apparently there's an infinite number of things on your body that can go wrong.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

GRETCHEN: My hairline's weird.

REGINA: My pores are huge.

KAREN: My nailbeds suck. *(The girls look at Cady. It is her turn.)*

CADY: *(struggling to come up with something)* I have really bad breath when I wake up in the morning.

REGINA: **(Pg 33-34)** *(cattily)* Gretchen told me that you like Aaron Samuels.

CADY: *(terrified)* What are you talking about?

REGINA: I mean, I don't care. *(obviously cares)* Do whatever you want. But wait. Aren't you so mad that Gretchen told me about this?

CADY: *(looks at Gretchen)* I'm not mad. *(trying to assume the attitude of "A Plastic")* She's just immature.

GRETCHEN: *(stomps her foot and pouts)* I can't believe you think I'm immature!

CADY: **(Pg 39)** *(to audience)* I knew how this would be settled in the wild. *(Regina leaps like a cheetah at Cady who chatters and howls like a monkey)* But in Girl world, all the fighting had to be invisible. *(shakes head)*

******* The Next day at the Mall *******

Damian and Cady go to visit Janis at Bath and Body Works where she is behind the counter working.

CADY: **(Pg 30-31)** And they have this book, this "Burnbook" where they write mean things about the girls in our grade.

DAMIAN: Rosemary Mint Foot Spray?

JANIS: It makes your feet smell like a salad. *(to Cadv)* Cady, you've got to steal that book. We could publish it and then everyone would see what an ax-wound she really is!

CADY: No way! I don't steal.

JANIS: There's two kinds of evil people, Cady. People who do evil stuff. And people who see evil stuff being done and don't do anything to stop it. **(Pg 79)** You're the worst. At least Regina George knows she's mean. You act like you're so innocent. *(imitating Cady)* I used to live in Africa with the birds and the monkeys." You're plastic! Solid, durable, molded plastic!

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

******* Principal's Office Monday Morning *******

Regina is fake crying to MR. DUVALL. He is reading the "Burnbook."

REGINA: (Pg 81) I found it in the girls' bathroom. It's so mean, Mr. Duvall.

MR. DUVALL: *(shocked)* Good Lord. What does that say? *(reads aloud)* Regina George is the nastiest *(clears throat)* I ever met. Do not trust her! She is an ugly *(clears throat)* . . .

REGINA: *(fake sobs)* Why would somebody write that? It's so mean!

MR. DUVALL: Okay, take a breath. We'll find out who did it.

REGINA: *(suddenly ice cold)* There's only three girls in the whole grade who aren't in it.

[Inserted as transition]

VOICE OVER: (Intercom off-stage): Cady Heron, Gretchen Wieners, and Karen Smith report to Mr. Duvall's office immediately. Cady Heron, Gretchen Wieners and Karen Smith report to Mr. Duvall's office.

******* Scene Change*******

CADY: (Pg 93) *(to audience)* Ms. Norbury had us write out apologies to people we had hurt in our lives. *(The girls read written "apologies" out loud)*

GIRL 1: Alyssa, I'm sorry I called you a gaptoothed b****. It's not your fault you're so gap-toothed.

GIRL 2: Laura, I don't hate you because you're fat. You're fat because I hate you.

GIRL 3: I iust wish we could all get· along like we used to in Middle School. I wish I could bake a cake made out of rainbows and smiles and we'd all eat it and be happy—

DAMIAN: She doesn't even go here!

CADY: (Pg 113) *(to audience)* I guess the biggest thing I learned at Evanston was that tearing other people down will not make your life any better. Calling somebody else fat will not make you any thinner. Telling someone they're stupid does not make you any smarter. **(Pg 117)** My first year of "real" school was like treading water in a shark tank, but now, I just float.

TOGETHER: *Do-Wap Baby Shark music and dance to end selection*

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Tina Fey based on the book Queen Bees and Wannabes by Rosalind Wiseman
ISBN: N/A
Publisher: Scriptfly.com
Date (Month/Year): Revised June 3, 2003 (Slightly Different than the Movie)

Original can be purchased from Scriptfly.com at
https://www.scriptfly.com/searchpage/resultpage.php?search=m

AWARD HISTORY

2008 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier - MS
2021 National Qualifier
MN State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY